

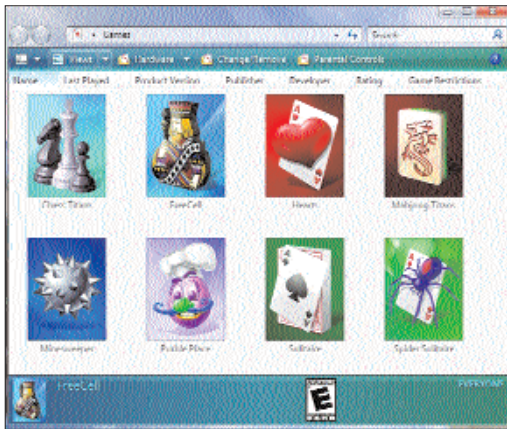
Device Independence

Vista will offer a printing engine code-named Metro. Similar to the PDF functionality offered by Mac OS X, this will ensure that any application can print to a common format. Metro, or XML Paper Specification as it is now called, will also be instrumental in ensuring that a document retains its formatting across devices—from a PDA to a cell phone to a personal computer.

In a demonstration of the technology, Bill Gates showed how saving a Word file or a photo will automatically generate a Metro document alongside. The Metro avatars can then be distributed across devices or printed.

Metro is built on top of Vista's XML-based Windows Presentation Foundation. The technologies will also let you create, and annotate documents, as well as to digitally sign and apply rights management to your creations.

This awareness of devices other than the desktop PC is inherent in Vista. The OS also offers better synchronisation capabilities—between PC and laptop, or between PC and other mobile devices such as a PDA. Vista will let you synchronise documents, photos or music across devices. This function also extends to the network, where the OS can cache files to a client system and only update changes across the client/ server link.



Icons will be scalable in Vista

PC-to-laptop interaction will also be underlined by the Mobility Center, a gathering of resources and applications to enhance and manage a portable computer.

Furthermore, Vista will bring better power management to both desktops and laptops. Vista will offer a Sleep mode that aims to marry the best of the current Hibernate and Standby modes. When a laptop's lid is closed, the unit will go into Standby mode, ready to be awakened in seconds. After a period of time spent under Standby (which can be changed), the laptop will hibernate.

Another feature touted by Vista, and which is already seeing support from laptop manufacturers such as ASUS, is the concept of SideShow.

SideShow basically takes advantage of falling LCD prices, and offers a solution to the very urgent need to conserve the battery life of a mobile device. A SideShow display for a laptop, as an example, can be a small monochrome LCD or an LED panel, attached on the lid of a laptop. Such a display will then offer a glance at important information such as new mails, your to-dos, battery life, appointments, and more.

A SideShow auxiliary display is not limited to the laptop—it could also be a desktop clock notifying you of new instant messages, for example.

Security

Microsoft is attempting to graft good security practices onto the very genes of Vista. To begin with, all Vista code is signed and certified by Microsoft, and can be monitored for changes. This level of code integrity is just the first step to building a stronger OS.

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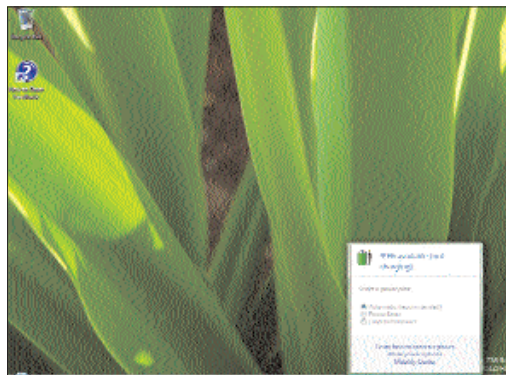
The Aero Glass interface will allow for 3D effects such as this [Alt] + [Tab] cascade—you can cycle through the Windows using the mouse wheel

service will also be able to transparently restart, if needed, reducing restarts after an update or a crash. Furthermore, every service will be monitored by the OS, and a service that doesn't need access to a certain hardware—say to a network port—will be denied access. This will go a long way in minimising spoof attacks or DoS attacks.

Vista will limit administrator-level access to unique situations. For regular day-to-day tasks, a user will not have the rights to make system-



A Live Icon



Power Management in Vista will be a simpler affair